Game Design Document

After dying on a rainy night in Japan, the player is reborn in a fantasy world. They grow up in a randomly assigned family, learn trades and combat disciplines through study and practice, and earn the trust of a party capable of defeating the Demon King.

CORE PLAY LOOP

Train or study, earn money through work and guild contracts, build relationships, then take on harder expeditions with a party. Recover when an expedition goes wrong and rebuild standing through reliable work.

A life shaped by practice and consequence

DESIGN PILLARS

Open professions. Family shapes starting opportunities. The player decides which disciplines to pursue.

Knowledge the player can use. Books teach magic directly. Training turns what the player learns into dependable skills.

A world that keeps moving. NPCs live their own lives. Death carries physical and social consequences after the fairy brings the player back.

CONTENTS

02 Prologue and second life

03 Skills and spellcasting

04 Guild, economy, and campaign

05 Death and Time Off

06 Calendar and time scale

07 Autonomous NPCs

08 Phased prototype plan

09 Open design decisions

Prologue and second life

Both opening choices end the protagonist's life in Japan and lead to a new life in the fantasy world.

The rainy night in Japan

CONFIRMED

The protagonist is playing Xbox in their room when their mother asks them to buy a drink. Outside, it is raining and already dark. A group of young people jostle one another on the way to the shop. One slips into the road as a heavy vehicle approaches. The cinematic slows down and hands the first choice to the player.

A Save the stranger

The protagonist pulls the stranger out of the vehicle's path, is struck, and dies beneath the vehicle.

Unlocks A New Beginning

B Keep walking

At an apparently empty shop, the protagonist surprises a robber while looking for the drink. The startled robber shoots and kills them.

No branch achievement

Reincarnation and family

The protagonist is reborn as a baby and retains memories of Japan. They must learn to use their new body and start without local knowledge, magical training, combat experience, or extraordinary powers. A randomly selected family, such as a farming, noble, merchant, or artisan household, shapes resources, contacts, and early opportunities. Every profession remains available from every family origin.

Playable childhood milestones

PROPOSED

Illustrative age	Activities to test
0-2	Recognize caregivers, begin learning the language, and learn to walk.
3-6	Learn to read, study, and discover early interests.
7-12	Train, meet teachers, and make friends.
13 onward	Gain independence, take paid work, and begin guild adventures.

Age bands, family selection weights, initial attributes, and appearance rules are open. Early play should establish the family and show how its circumstances affect the first opportunities.

Skills and spellcasting

Characters improve through what they do. A swordsman can study magic, and a mage can learn swordsmanship.

Practice and study

CONFIRMED

Swordsmanship. Repeated practice develops proficiency gradually. Training covers techniques, stances, and styles. Learning several disciplines takes time, and each develops through its own practice.

Magic. Libraries hold books with fully readable text that teaches magical principles and actual incantations. Players read, try what they learn, and practice to improve mana control and mastery. The player can experiment with the material as their character gains capability.

Spoken casting and overreach

The player speaks the incantation into a microphone to cast. A spell can exceed a character's capacity because of low current mana, youth, insufficient practice, or the spell's difficulty. Overreaching causes collapse and a shorter Time Off than death.

A shared casting sequence

PROPOSED

Step	Prototype behavior
1. Learn	Read a primer with the incantation, its purpose, and a safe practice exercise.
2. Enter	Speak with push-to-talk or use remappable input to assemble the same incantation.
3. Verify	Show which phrase the game received. Unclear input gives feedback and a free retry.
4. Resolve	A valid attempt checks mana and mastery. Success spends mana and casts. A confirmed overreach causes collapse and short Time Off.

Speech and reading access

Offer the non-speaking path from the first spell, with the same spells, costs, risks, and rewards, and comparable casting time. Support remapping, visible incantations, adjustable text, and calibration. Test with the mic denied or disconnected, with noise, and across accents and speech differences.

Use explicit mic activation and visible listening status. Evaluate on-device recognition and avoid retaining raw audio by default. Spell composition, written formulas, silent casting as an in-world technique, and undocumented spell discovery remain exploratory.

Guild, economy, and campaign

The guild connects paid work, public standing, and party recruitment to the campaign against the Demon King.

Guild contracts and advancement

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Players register as adventurers, start with straightforward jobs, and earn access to more dangerous contracts through reliable performance and higher rank. Contracts pay money. Parties can set entry requirements and consider an applicant's reputation before offering a place.

F	E and D	C and B	A	S
Entry and demotion floor	Developing	Experienced	Elite	Legendary

Reputation and parties

Completed contracts and dependable participation build reputation. Repeated deaths and missed commitments can erode trust and lower guild rank all the way to F. A highly skilled mage can hold the lowest guild rank. If a party replaces a player who cannot join it during recovery, the player can seek a new party or attempt to repair the relationship.

Income and costs

Paid work and guild missions support the character's living costs. Books, training, equipment, and travel can also cost money. The player chooses which expenses support their immediate goals and which can wait.

The Demon King

The long-term objective is to assemble a party and defeat the Demon King. The player prepares by developing skills, earning money, building standing with the guild, and recruiting capable companions.

Social rules and campaign structure

OPEN

Define contract eligibility, promotion and demotion thresholds, payout and price curves, party recruitment and removal rules, and ways to rebuild trust. Choose how the final campaign unlocks, what the encounter demands of the party, and what follows victory.

Death and Time Off

The fairy restores the player to life. Recovery changes what the player can take on and what others can rely on them to do.

Resurrection in the fantasy world

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Reincarnation gives the protagonist a special condition. When the character dies in the fantasy world, a fairy appears and brings them back. Knowledge and years of training survive. The resurrected character enters Time Off with reduced maximum health, mana, stamina, and other affected attributes.

The player can continue playing during Time Off. Attributes recover progressively as time passes. A further death before full recovery compounds the penalty by extending Time Off, prolonging the period of reduced stats. Taking a dangerous contract while weakened carries a higher risk of another death.

Consequences while the world advances

The player can miss a contract or be unable to accompany their party. A party may replace them. Repeated deaths and unfulfilled obligations can lower reputation enough for the guild to demote them to F.

Event	Immediate result	Recovery
Spell overreach	Collapse after an attempt beyond capacity.	Short Time Off.
Fantasy-world death	Fairy resurrection and reduced stat maxima.	Longer Time Off.
Death during Time Off	Fairy resurrection with recovery still active.	Compounding Time Off.

Recovery tuning and feedback

PROPOSED

Use a visible timer and a preview of affected stats. Provide lower-risk activities such as reading or light work so the player has options while recovering. Test a temporary safe return point to avoid immediate re-death.

Illustrative tuning. A 7-, 14-, and 28-game-day sequence for successive deaths would take 70, 140, and 280 real minutes at the standard world rate. These lengths can consume multiple sessions. Prototype with shorter values and measure missed opportunities and the temptation to return early.

Open. Fairy identity and return point, recovery clock and stacking cap, deeper stat penalties on repeat deaths, collapse during active Time Off, and any inventory or contract-specific loss.

Calendar and time scale

The fantasy world has its own calendar and a day-and-night cycle. One complete in-game day takes 10 real minutes at normal speed.

Normal world time

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The world advances as the character studies, trains, works, or rests. NPC routines, services, and deadlines must remain legible as days pass. The length of a year and the naming of dates belong to the fantasy calendar.

Elapsed game time	Elapsed real time	Basis
1 day	10 minutes	Confirmed normal rate
6 days	1 hour	Normal rate
365-day year	60 h 50 min / 2.53 days	Illustrative calendar
1,000-day year	166 h 40 min / 6.94 days	Illustrative calendar
Birth to age 18	45.63 days	365-day year at normal rate

Conversions assume uninterrupted simulation. With an illustrative 24-hour clock, a game hour lasts 25 real seconds, and a six-hour opening window lasts two and a half real minutes.

Pacing tests

PROPOSED

Childhood and aging. Use playable milestones with explicit time jumps between them. Advance household and NPC events across each jump and summarize consequential changes when play resumes. Test a shorter year as another way to speed aging while keeping the day length. It also makes annual events recur more often.

Daily access. Test shop windows, training, travel, and deadlines within short sessions. Show local time and closing hours, use forgiving windows for essential services, and provide access to schedules without requiring the player to memorize the calendar.

Reading and recovery. Test extended access windows and an optional reading pause. Apply Time Off recovery and contract deadlines consistently when a calendar jump advances the world.

Open. Months, seasons, holidays, daylight split, age cadence, permitted skips, pause behaviour, and whether the world advances while the game is closed.

Autonomous NPCs

NPCs have lives of their own. They can be born, grow, learn, make decisions, and die as the world advances.

A living cast

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NPC lives and relationships can change during the player's studies, work, and recovery. The player's choices, family circumstances, and the passage of time create different opportunities across playthroughs. A party may continue its work while the player recovers.

Settlement simulation

PROPOSED

Give a small set of NPCs a household, age, role, relationships, routine, and skills. A schedule picks ordinary activities. Relevant events and local conditions can change the schedule. NPCs learn from repeated activities, and birth and death update household membership and role availability.

System	Prototype behavior	Player-visible result
Daily routine	A merchant opens and closes according to a schedule.	The player can see when the shop is available.
Learning	A trainee practices and gains skill across days.	The trainee can become useful on a contract.
Birth and growth	A household gains a child through a scheduled event.	Residents and family relationships change.
Death	A deceased NPC leaves the active cast and releases their role.	An essential service can move to a successor.

Persistence and continuity

Save each NPC's identity, skills, household, and pending events. Resolve each event once across saves. Use repeatable test runs for births, deaths, and learning. Test a coarser update schedule before growing the population.

Use substitute teachers and service successors where essential access would otherwise disappear. Let the loss of a specific relationship matter even when another NPC takes over the role.

How far the world acts independently

OPEN

Decide which NPC decisions need richer behavior, how companion deaths affect the party, and how much population history to preserve. Independent wars, competing guild parties, and a Demon King campaign that advances on its own remain proposals.

Phased prototype plan

Proposed scope is one village and a short playable route through the linked systems. Use temporary assets and a test clock.

01 Establish the life loop

Storyboard both Japan branches. Build two starting households, a small training yard, one playable childhood transition, and the 10-minute day.

Exit criteria. Both branches reach reincarnation. Only the rescue awards *A New Beginning*. Both families can reach the same starter disciplines. A timed run completes a full day and night in 10 minutes.

02 Prove study and casting

Create a readable primer and two spells, including one beyond the starting character's capacity. Add a practice exercise, microphone input, and a non-speaking input path.

Exit criteria. A player can learn and cast with the mic disabled. Both inputs use the same mana, skill, and resolution rules. Recognition failure permits a free retry. Valid overreach triggers collapse and shorter Time Off than death.

03 Connect recovery to guild play

Add a guild desk, a few paid contracts, a merchant, one recruitable party, and fairy resurrection. Use temporary rank thresholds and tunable recovery values.

Exit criteria. The player earns and spends money, keeps learned skills after death, returns with lower stat maxima, and extends recovery by dying again during Time Off. Missed obligations can cost a party slot. A test run reaches F through lost reputation and rebuilds standing through reliable work.

04 Test the living world in a full playthrough

Simulate a small persistent cast in the village. Use an accelerated test clock to exercise birth, aging, learning, and death. End the slice with a contract that previews preparation for the Demon King.

Exit criteria. NPC life events occur without player triggers and persist through save and reload. Essential services remain reachable. Recovery, party membership, rank, rewards, and deadlines restore consistently after reload.

Scope beyond the prototype

LATER PRODUCTION

Schedule final cinematics, a large library, world-scale simulation, open-ended spell construction, and the finished Demon King encounter after the playable slice passes its exit criteria.

Open design decisions

The first prototype should resolve the rules that govern access, pacing, and failure across the game's systems.

Area	Decision to make	Evidence to review
Time and aging	Choose calendar length, childhood pacing, and offline and pause rules.	Time to reach adult play, missed services, and skipped life events.
Birth and training	Choose household weights, starting traits, practice gains, and teacher access.	Viable training routes from each household and a meaningful pace of improvement.
Combat and magic	Choose combat controls, damage rules, recognition approach, and mastery checks.	Learning and casting success across inputs and the causes of failed attempts.
Death and guild	Choose respawn point, recovery caps, rank thresholds, and party removal rules.	Recovery time, repeat deaths, missed contracts, and viable paths back from F.
World and campaign	Choose NPC simulation scale, companion mortality, Demon King progression, and post-victory play.	Save continuity, essential service coverage, and clear campaign preparation.

Achievement backlog

PROPOSED

Beyond the confirmed *A New Beginning*, candidates include learning to read early, winning a first training duel, earning first pay, forming a first party, dying a second time, surviving several dangerous encounters, and defeating the Demon King without using resurrection.

Original world and characters

CREATIVE REFERENCES

Mushoku Tensei informed the discussion of reincarnation, learning, and growth. *KonoSuba* informed the discussion of guilds, parties, and adventurer finances. *Frieren: Beyond Journey's End* informed the discussion of magic, exploration, and the passage of time.

Create original characters, lore, locations, spell language, and assets. The Xbox reference describes the current prologue storyboard. Decide during production how to depict the console on screen.

Design source · Pronunciación de engine and the version 0.1 project brief.